

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39

High-Yield Revision Cheat Sheet

1. Master Glossary

Term	Definition
25-Point Programme	The foundational manifesto of the Nazi Party, written in 1920, containing their core political demands.
Active Resistance	Direct attempts to overthrow or damage the government, such as assassination plots or publishing illegal leaflets.
Anti-Semitism	Hatred or discrimination against Jewish people.
Armistice	A formal agreement to end hostilities in a war (Signed 11 November 1918).
Article 109	The clause in the Weimar Constitution that legally guaranteed women equal rights with men.
Article 48	undefined
Aryan	undefined
Aryanisation	The forced transfer of Jewish-owned businesses and property to Aryans at a fraction of their value.
Asocials	People who did not fit the Nazi social ideal of the Volksgemeinschaft (e.g., homosexuals, vagrants, alcoholics).
Autarky	The economic policy of self-sufficiency; trying to produce everything Germany needed so it would not rely on imports during a war.
Avant-garde	New, experimental, and radical ideas in art and culture.
Backstairs Intrigue	undefined
Bauhaus	A revolutionary school of architecture and design, founded by Walter Gropius, that focused on simplicity, modern materials, and functionality.
Beauty of Labour (SdA)	A subdivision of the DAF aimed at improving workplace conditions (like canteens and lighting).
Bernhard Rust	The Nazi Minister of Science, Education and National Culture.
Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM)	The League of German Maidens (for girls aged 14–18).
Cabinet	undefined

Term	Definition
Censorship	The government banning or hiding information, preventing the public from seeing anything critical of the regime.
Coalition Government	A government formed of two or more political parties joining together when no single party wins a majority.
Confessional Church	An illegal, breakaway Protestant church set up in direct opposition to the Nazis' interference in religion.
Conformity	Doing what you are told and blending in with the crowd to avoid drawing attention to yourself.
Constitution	A set of written rules and laws that sets out exactly how a country is governed.
DAP (German Workers' Party)	The original, tiny political party founded by Anton Drexler in 1919.
Dawes Plan (1924)	An economic agreement where the USA lent Germany 800 million gold marks to rebuild its industry and restructured reparation payments.
Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW)	The massive German Women's Enterprise, overseen by the NSF, designed to educate women on domestic duties.
Diktat	A dictated peace; the bitter German view of the Treaty of Versailles because they were not allowed to negotiate its terms.
Dolchstoßlegende	The toxic right-wing myth that the German army was not defeated on the battlefield but betrayed by politicians at home.
Edelweiss Pirates	A working-class youth opposition group that rebelled against the strict, militaristic rules of the Hitler Youth.
Entartete Kunst (Degenerate Art)	The Nazi term for modern, abstract, or expressionist art, which they banned for being 'un-German'.
Ersatz	Artificial substitute goods developed to help achieve Autarky (e.g., making rubber from coal).
Eugenics	The pseudo-science of selective breeding to 'purify' the human race.
Eugenics (Race Studies)	The pseudo-science of selective breeding to improve the 'Aryan' race, taught as a compulsory subject.
Faith and Beauty Society	A Nazi organisation for women aged 17–21, designed to bridge the gap between the BDM and adult life.
Franz von Papen	undefined
Freikorps	Right-wing, anti-communist private armies made up of fiercely nationalistic, demobilised ex-soldiers.

Term	Definition
Führerprinzip (The Leadership Principle)	undefined
Gauleiter	undefined
German Labour Front (DAF)	The Nazi organisation that replaced trade unions, led by Robert Ley.
Gertrud Scholtz-Klink	The Reich Women's Leader, appointed by Hitler to oversee all women's organisations.
Gestapo	The official non-uniformed Secret State Police. Their primary job was to identify, arrest, and interrogate political opponents.
Heinrich Brüning	undefined
Hermann Goering	The Nazi minister put in charge of the 'Four Year Plan' in 1936 to prepare the economy for war.
Hermann Müller	undefined
Hitlerjugend (HJ)	The Hitler Youth (for boys aged 14–18).
Hyperinflation	A catastrophic economic crisis where the value of money plummets uncontrollably, leading to massive, rapid price rises.
Indoctrination	Brainwashing people to accept a set of beliefs without question.
Invisible Unemployment	The Nazi practice of manipulating statistics to hide the true number of people out of work.
Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928)	An international agreement signed by 65 countries, including Germany, promising to resolve conflicts peacefully rather than using war.
Kinder, Küche, Kirche	"Children, Kitchen, Church" – the traditional slogan that summarised the Nazi ideal for women.
KPD (Communist Party of Germany)	undefined
Kurt von Schleicher	undefined
Landsberg Prison	undefined
Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933)	A law providing government loans to young couples, provided the wife left her job.
League of Nations	The international peacekeeping organization; Germany was admitted in 1926, restoring its status as a trusted 'great power'.

Term	Definition
Lebensborn (Spring of Life)	A program started by Heinrich Himmler in 1935 to breed 'racially pure' Aryan children.
Locarno Pact (1925)	A diplomatic treaty between Germany, Britain, France, Italy, and Belgium where Germany agreed to accept its western borders.
Mein Kampf ('My Struggle')	undefined
Ministry of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda	The government department created in 1933, led by Dr Joseph Goebbels, to control the media.
National Labour Service (RAD)	A scheme providing manual work for the unemployed, made compulsory for young men in 1935.
National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB)	The compulsory Nazi union for all teachers.
Nationalism	A fierce, devoted love of one's country, often coupled with the belief that it is superior to others and must be kept militarily strong.
Negative Cohesion	undefined
New Objectivity (Neue Sachlichkeit)	An artistic movement that rejected romanticism and instead painted the harsh, gritty, and often ugly reality of everyday German society.
New Woman (Neue Frau)	The media's term for the liberated, independent, and fashion-conscious young women of 1920s city life.
November Criminals	The insulting nickname given by right-wing nationalists to the democratic politicians who accepted the Armistice.
NS-Frauenschaft (NSF)	The elite National Socialist Women's League.
NSDAP (National Socialist German Workers' Party)	The new name given to the DAP by Hitler in 1920 (abbreviated to 'Nazi').
Passive Resistance	Low-level, non-violent opposition, such as refusing to do the 'Heil Hitler' salute or telling anti-Nazi jokes.
Paul von Hindenburg	undefined
Propaganda	Spreading highly biased, one-sided information to manipulate how people think and behave.
Proportional Representation (PR)	An electoral method where the proportion of seats a party gains is exactly equal to its share of the vote.

Term	Definition
Putsch	A violent, armed attempt to overthrow the government.
Reich Chamber of Culture	A state-run organisation that controlled all the arts; you could not work as an artist or musician unless you were a member.
Reich Church	A Nazified version of the Protestant Church, which merged traditional Christianity with Nazi racial ideas.
Reichsmark	The permanent, stable new German currency introduced in 1924, backed by gold reserves.
Reichsrat	The second (upper) house of parliament, made up of representatives from Germany's 18 local regions (Länder).
Reichstag	The main house of the German state parliament where elected politicians met to pass laws.
Rentenmark	The temporary currency introduced by Stresemann in November 1923 to end hyperinflation, based on property and land values.
Reparations	Massive compensation payments demanded by the victorious Allies to pay for war damage.
Rotfrontkämpferbund (Red Front Fighters' League)	undefined
SA (Sturmabteilung)	The private army of the Nazi Party, also known as the 'Brownshirts', set up in 1921 and commanded by Ernst Röhm.
Sabotage	Deliberately destroying, damaging, or obstructing something, often used by workers in Nazi factories.
Schutzhaft (Protective Custody)	A Nazi legal loophole that allowed the Gestapo to arrest and imprison anyone indefinitely without a trial or judge's permission.
SD (Sicherheitsdienst)	The intelligence and security agency of the Nazi Party, commanded by Reinhard Heydrich. They spied on opponents.
Social Darwinism	The twisted Nazi belief that human races evolve like animals, and the 'strong' (Aryans) must destroy the 'weak' to survive.
Socialism	A political idea where wealth and property are shared more equally among the working people, and large corporations are controlled by the state.
Sopade Reports	Secret reports smuggled out of Germany by the banned Social Democratic Party (SPD) to track the true mood of the German public.
Spartacist League	An extreme left-wing (communist) group led by Rosa Luxemburg and Karl Liebknecht.

Term	Definition
SS (Schutzstaffel)	Originally Hitler's private bodyguards, they became the most powerful armed force in Germany, running the police state and concentration camps under Heinrich Himmler.
Standard of Living	The level of wealth, comfort, and material goods available to a certain socioeconomic class.
Stosstrupp (Shock Troop)	An elite, highly trusted unit selected from the SA to act as Hitler's personal bodyguard.
Strength Through Joy (KdF)	A subdivision of the DAF that provided cheap leisure activities to bribe workers into compliance.
Swing Youth	A middle-class youth opposition group that rebelled by embracing banned American culture, jazz music, and fashion.
The Bavarian Triumvirate	undefined
The Camarilla	undefined
The Concordat (1933)	A formal treaty signed between the Nazi government and the Catholic Pope.
The Mother's Cross (Mutterkreuz)	An award given to women who had large numbers of children, treated like a military medal.
The Wall Street Crash	undefined
Treason	undefined
Unemployment Insurance Act (1927)	A national scheme requiring workers and employers to contribute to a central fund, which provided benefits to the unemployed and sick.
Untermenschen	'Sub-humans'—groups the Nazis believed were biologically inferior (Jews, Roma/Sinti, Slavs).
Völkischer Beobachter	The official newspaper of the Nazi Party, purchased in 1920 to spread their propaganda.
Volksempfänger (People's Receiver)	A cheap, mass-produced radio designed so that ordinary Germans could afford to listen to Hitler's speeches.
Volksgemeinschaft	The 'People's Community'—the Nazi ideal of a pure, strong, and united Aryan society.
Young Plan (1929)	A renegotiation of the Treaty of Versailles that reduced total reparations from £6.6 billion to £2 billion and gave Germany 59 extra years to pay.

2. Key Individuals Matrix

Kaiser Wilhelm II

Emperor of Germany

The last German Emperor and King of Prussia, ruling from 1888 to 1918. He was forced to abdicate on 9 November 1918 following a wave of mutinies and the looming defeat in the First World War.

Philipp Scheidemann

SPD Politician

A leading member of the Social Democratic Party who famously rushed to the balcony of the Reichstag on 9 November 1918 to proclaim the new German Republic.

Friedrich Ebert

Leader of the Social Democratic Party (SPD) who became the first President of the Weimar Republic. He was responsible for declaring the new republic following the Kaiser's abdication, signing the armistice to end the First World War, and negotiating the Ebert-Groener Pact with the army to restore order in Berlin.

Prince Max von Baden

The Kaiser's last Imperial Chancellor. He announced the abdication of Kaiser Wilhelm II in November 1918 and handed over executive chancellorship to Friedrich Ebert to manage a relatively peaceful transition of power and prevent a violent, communist-style revolution.

Woodrow Wilson

President of the United States who formulated the "Fourteen Points" after WWI. German citizens expected the Treaty of Versailles to be based on his principles of fair self-determination, making the actual harsh terms of the treaty a shocking betrayal—the dictated peace or 'Diktat'.

Matthias Erzberger

Moderate Centre Party politician who headed the German delegation and signed the 1918 Armistice. He was labeled a "November Criminal" who stabbed the military in the back ('Dolchstoß'), and was subsequently assassinated by right-wing nationalists in 1921.

Walther Rathenau

The Weimar Foreign Minister who negotiated the Rapallo Treaty. He was assassinated by right-wing nationalists in 1922, illustrating the extreme political violence and instability threatening the early Weimar state.

Rosa Luxemburg

Leaders of the extreme left-wing Spartacist League. They launched the failed Spartacist Uprising in Berlin in January 1919, attempting to overthrow the government and set up a communist-style state, before being captured and executed by the Freikorps.

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Wolfgang Kapp

Right-wing politician who led the failed Kapp Putsch in March 1920. Backed by Freikorps units refusing to disarm, he briefly seized Berlin and forced the Weimar government to flee, but his coup collapsed after a general strike called by Ebert paralyzed the city's infrastructure.

Gustav Stresemann

Appointed Chancellor in August 1923 and Foreign Minister from 1924 to 1929. He was the central figure of Weimar's recovery, introducing the Rentenmark to end hyperinflation, negotiating the Dawes and Young Plans to reduce reparations, securing French withdrawal from the Ruhr, and gaining international acceptance via the Locarno Pact and entry into the League of Nations.

Walter Gropius

Modernist architect who founded the famous Bauhaus design school in Dessau. His work pioneered functionalism in architecture and design, representing the bold experimentation and cultural freedom of Weimar's "Golden Age".

Marlene Dietrich

Famous Weimar actress who starred in the ground-breaking film 'The Blue Angel' (1930). She came to represent the "New Woman" of the era—independent, glamorous, and challenging traditional gender roles.

George Grosz & Otto Dix

Prominent Expressionist and 'Neue Sachlichkeit' (New Objectivity) artists. They used their paintings to depict the harsh social realities of post-war Germany, including war-disabled veterans, poverty, and political hypocrisy, showing the deep societal divisions underneath Weimar's glitz.

Dr. Magnus Hirschfeld

Pioneer of sexual science who founded the Institute for Sexual Science in Berlin. He was a prominent advocate for LGBT rights and sex reform during the socially progressive Weimar years.

Adolf Hitler

A decorated WWI veteran who joined the German Workers' Party (DAP) as a military intelligence agent in 1919. He took control of the party through his powerful public speaking, co-authored the Twenty-Five Point Programme, introduced the swastika, and established the SA to secure his position as absolute leader ('Führer').

Ernst Röhm

Co-founder and commander of the Sturmabteilung (SA). A hard-line ex-army officer, he recruited violent paramilitary thugs to protect Nazi meetings and disrupt opposing left-wing assemblies.

Hermann Goering

Minister in charge of the Four Year Plan

A highly decorated First World War fighter pilot who joined the Nazi Party in 1922. He brought prestige, military discipline, and upper-class contacts to the early party leadership, and later founded the Gestapo.

Julius Streicher

Extreme anti-Semitic publisher who founded the propaganda newspaper 'Der Stürmer' in 1923. He used his platform to spread virulently anti-Jewish conspiracy theories and strengthen support for Hitler's racial ideology.

Anton Drexler

A Munich locksmith who founded the German Workers' Party (DAP) in 1919. He served as Hitler's early political mentor but was gradually pushed aside as Hitler took total control of the renamed NSDAP.

Rudolf Hess

Hitler's devoted private secretary and early party member who was imprisoned with Hitler after the Munich Putsch and helped transcribe 'Mein Kampf'.

Gregor Strasser

A powerful northern German Gauleiter who led the socialist-leaning faction of the Nazi Party in the mid-1920s. He challenged Hitler's southern, nationalist wing until Hitler re-established his supreme authority at the Bamberg Conference of 1926.

General Erich Ludendorff

Legendary First World War military commander who marched alongside Hitler during the failed Munich Putsch in November 1923. His participation was intended to win the support of the German army, though he was acquitted at the subsequent trial.

Joseph Goebbels

Minister of Public Enlightenment and Propaganda

Appointed head of Nazi propaganda (Gauleiter of Berlin) in 1926. He brilliantly coordinated Nazi election campaigns during the Great Depression, using modern technology (radio, loudspeakers, and aeroplanes for "Hitler over Germany" tours) and targeted posters to win over different interest groups.

Heinrich Brüning

Centre Party Chancellor from 1930 to 1932. Nicknamed the "Hunger Chancellor" because of his highly unpopular austerity measures (cutting unemployment benefits and raising taxes), he bypassed the Reichstag by ruling through Hindenburg's emergency decrees (Article 48), which destabilized Weimar democracy.

Ernst Thälmann

Leader of the German Communist Party (KPD). He was Hitler's key rival on the extreme left during the elections of the early 1930s, gaining major support among the unemployed and raising middle-class fears of a communist revolution.

Paul von Hindenburg

Celebrated WWI military hero and second President of the Weimar Republic. Though he deeply disliked Hitler (calling him a "Bohemian corporal"), he was persuaded by conservative politicians to appoint him as Chancellor in January 1933 to resolve the political deadlock.

Franz von Papen

Conservative politician and former Chancellor. He conspired with Hindenburg's inner circle to oust Schleicher, plotting to make Hitler Chancellor in a coalition cabinet where Papen (as Vice-Chancellor) believed he could control Hitler like a puppet.

Kurt von Schleicher

An influential army general and Chancellor (December 1932–January 1933). He attempted to split the Nazi Party by offering Gregor Strasser a government post, but failed and was replaced by Hitler, before being assassinated during the Night of the Long Knives.

Marinus van der Lubbe

A young Dutch communist arrested, tried, and executed for setting fire to the Reichstag building in February 1933. Hitler used his arrest to claim a massive communist conspiracy, justifying the suspension of civil liberties.

Heinrich Himmler

Head of the SS (Schutzstaffel). He systematically consolidated control over all German police forces, the Gestapo, and the expanding concentration camp system (starting with Dachau in 1933) to build the central apparatus of the police state.

Reinhard Heydrich

Head of the SD and the Gestapo

Deputy to Himmler and head of the SD (the Nazi Security Service) and Gestapo. He orchestrated a massive network of surveillance, file-keeping, and terror to hunt down and eliminate all political opponents of the regime.

Albert Speer

Hitler's Chief Architect

Hitler's personal architect and close ally. He designed monumental, classical-style Nazi structures (such as the Nuremberg Rally grounds) to project the state's power, permanence, and dominance over the individual.

Jesse Owens

American Olympic Athlete

African-American track and field athlete who won 4 gold medals at the 1936 Berlin Olympics. His spectacular athletic success directly contradicted Goebbels' propaganda aims and Nazi racial theories of Aryan supremacy.

Martin Niemöller

A prominent Protestant pastor who supported early right-wing ideals but fiercely opposed the state-controlled Reich Church. He co-founded the Pastors' Emergency League (PEL) and the Confessing Church. He was imprisoned in concentration camps from 1937 to 1945 and is famous for his post-war poem "First they came...".

George Elser

A German carpenter who opposed the Nazi dictatorship on moral grounds. In November 1939, he planned and executed a highly sophisticated solo bomb plot at the Bürgerbräukeller in Munich, narrowly missing assassinating Hitler.

Dietrich Bonhoeffer

Theologian and Anti-Nazi Dissident

Protestant theologian and pastor who actively worked against the Nazi regime's anti-Semitic policies and the Reich Church. He joined the military intelligence (Abwehr) resistance network and was eventually executed for his involvement in plans to overthrow Hitler.

Carl von Ossietzky

Pacifist, journalist, and outspoken anti-Nazi critic who exposed clandestine German rearmament. He was sent to a concentration camp in 1933 and awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1935 while imprisoned, causing a diplomatic embarrassment for the regime.

August Landmesser

A shipyard worker famously photographed in 1936 refusing to perform the "Heil Hitler" salute during a mass rally, persecuted for his relationship with a Jewish woman under the Nuremberg Laws.

Gertrud Scholtz-Klink

Reich Women's Leader

Appointed Reich Women's Leader ('Reichsfrauenführerin'). Her role was to oversee all Nazi women's organizations and ensure that German women conformed to the domestic ideals of marriage, child-rearing, and motherhood ('Kinder, Küche, Kirche').

Bernhard Rust

Minister of Science, Education and National Culture

Reich Minister of Science, Education, and National Culture. He coordinated the radical Nazification of the school curriculum, rewrote textbooks, forced teachers to swear loyalty oaths, and turned schools into instruments of racial and ideological indoctrination.

Judith Kerr

A young Jewish girl who fled Germany with her family in 1933 just before her father, a prominent anti-Nazi critic, was to be arrested. She later detailed her experience as a refugee in her semi-autobiographical book 'When Hitler Stole Pink Rabbit'.

Anna Lehnkering

A disabled teenager who struggled in school and was sent to an institution. She was forcibly sterilized by the Nazis at age 19 under the Sterilisation Law and later murdered under the T4 Euthanasia Programme, representing the thousands of victims of Nazi eugenics.

Friedrich-Paul von Groszheim

A young German man arrested and tortured by the Gestapo under Paragraph 175 for being homosexual. He was forcibly sterilized as a condition of his release, illustrating the brutal state-sponsored persecution of social minorities.